

high-end mobile phones could have arrested the burgeoning smuggled market, which has crossed ₹120 billion, in 2023. This measure would have boosted government revenue, reduced smuggling, ensured fair trade, and helped build legal businesses in India.

2. Removal of input duties on Resin, Mesh, Sponge, Film, Gasket, Logo, Cover Tape, and Adhesive Tape from 8.25% - 16.5% to zero level was essential to promote the manufacturing of a very critical vertical—Mechanics. But the Budget didn't provide the needed relief in this direction.

3. Input duties of 2.75%, the duty imposed in the previous Budget on the many inputs of PCBA, inputs of connector, and inputs of camera module were not removed.

4. Removal of duty on certain parts of the chargers would have provided the huge charger manufacturing industry with a competitive edge.

5. The 50% increase in GST from 12% to 18% has dealt a very cruel hand to this high-performing industry, which kept the nation's economy moving during the Covid pandemic.

ICEA opined that while the industry had met the 2021-22 manufacturing target of ₹2,750 billion, we will fall short of the manufacturing target of FY 2022-23 because of domestic demand shrinking in 2022-23. Mohindroo added that, competi-

TABLE 2
8524: FLAT PANEL DISPLAY MODULES, WHETHER OR NOT INCORPORATING TOUCH-SENSITIVE SCREENS

S. No.	Previous HSC	Description	Revised HS Lines (Finance Bill 2023)	Description
1	8524 11 00	Of Liquid Crystal	8524 11 10	For the goods of sub-heading 8471 30 or 8471 41
			8524 11 20	For the goods of sub-heading 8517 13 or 8517 14
			8524 11 30	For the goods of sub-heading 8528 72 or 8528 73
			8524 11 90	Other
2	8524 12 00	Of organic light-emitting diodes (OLED)	8524 12 10	For the goods of sub-heading 8471 30 or 8471 41
			8524 12 20	For the goods of sub-heading 8517 13 or 8517 14
			8524 12 30	For the goods of sub-heading 8528 72 or 8528 73
			8524 12 90	Other
3	8524 19 00	Other	8524 19 10	For the goods of sub-heading 8471 30 or 8471 41
			8524 19 20	For the goods of sub-heading 8517 13 or 8517 14
			8524 19 30	For the goods of sub-heading 8528 72 or 8528 73
			8524 19 90	Other
4	8524 91 00	Of liquid crystals	8524 91 10	For the goods of sub-heading 8471 30 or 8471 41
			8524 91 20	For the goods of sub-heading 8517 13 or 8517 14
			8524 91 30	For the goods of sub-heading 8528 72 or 8528 73
			8524 91 90	Other
5	8524 92 00	Of organic light-emitting diodes (OLED)	8524 92 10	For the goods of sub-heading 8471 30 or 8471 41
			8524 92 20	For the goods of sub-heading 8517 13 or 8517 14
			8524 92 30	For the goods of sub-heading 8528 72 or 8528 73
			8524 92 90	Other
6	8524 99 00	Other	8524 99 10	For the goods of sub-heading 8471 30 or 8471 41
			8524 99 20	For the goods of sub-heading 8517 13 or 8517 14
			8524 99 30	For the goods of sub-heading 8528 72 or 8528 73
			8524 99 90	Other

(Courtesy: ICEA)

tiveness is the key to both buoyant domestic demand and export.

In a post-Budget session conducted by ELCINA, long-term and enhanced support for components manufacturing under PLI and the Scheme for Promotion of Manufacturing of Electronic Components and Semiconductors (SPECs) was recommended. The association also stated that the EMS sector must be included under the SPECs scheme to provide subsidies against capital investments, as it will hopefully give the required thrust to value addition and boost electronics manufacturing in all segments.

Some industry players suggested bringing Service Linked Incentive Schemes, on the lines of Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Schemes, to improve the workflow. Going

forward, deeper digital and Internet of Things (IoT) penetration and the ever-increasing impetus on smart cities and robotics will boost the industrial and automated electronics sector in Industry 4.0. Also, the PLI scheme is expected to assist more domestic players to achieve economies of scale in production through localising. In turn, it will magnify India's role in the global value chain and enhance export competitiveness. What remains to be seen, though, is the effective implementation of the initiatives announced for India's Amrit Kaal. **EFY**

The Secretary General at ELCINA, Rajoo Goel, noted the Finance Minister's announcement to reduce customs duty on parts of open cell of TV panels to 2.5% from 5% earlier. "All this will create demand for electronics hardware and create jobs as well in the electronics industry. The Finance Minister has laid a lot of emphasis on skill development for green energy products, drones, robotics, and IoT. All these are positive developments for the electronics sector," commented Goel.

Vaishali Yadav, a journalist at EFY, muses upon clouds, security, sustainability, integration, smartness, machines and learning—both trivially and technologically